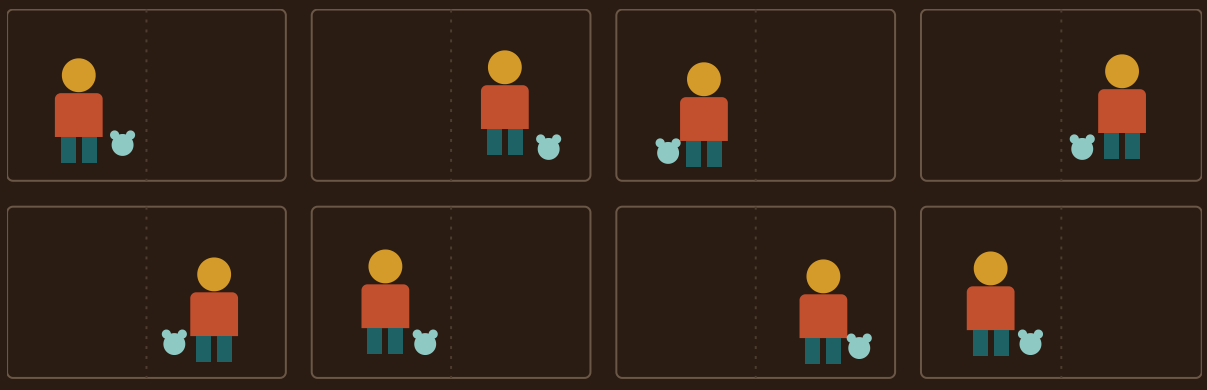
GIFTMYBOOK · CHILDREN'S WORKER

Twelve pictures, *one* child.

How the illustrator keeps the same child, the same outfit, the same companion and the same objects across every spread of an AI-illustrated children's book. Verified against the source code.



SCOPE
Character, outfit, companion and object consistency in the slim illustrator

ENGINE STATE
STYLE_VERSION ce-22
QA_VERSION qa-17 · so-planner-7

BASIS
Source audit of the illustrator, November 2026

SUMMARY

01 The problem and the answer

A picture book is twelve illustrations of the same child in the same clothes, with the same friend and the same teddy bear. An image model draws each of them with no memory of the other eleven.

Every spread is a **stateless render**: one independent call to an image model. Held to prose alone, the model reinvented the trousers, the shoes, the species of the comfort toy and the face of the farmer on every page. Each picture was fine alone; the set did not read as one book.

The fix changed *what* a render is held to and *how* a render is accepted:

- **Each identity is an image plus a spec, built once per book** and collected in a hashed manifest, the Book Bible: a character model sheet, an outfit spec read off that sheet, a sheet per personal object, a sheet per companion, and a plan for every plot object.
- **Every render gets the same labelled reference pack** and prompt blocks rendered from that manifest.
- **Every render is judged with the sheets attached beside it**, garment by garment and object by object, into fixed defect strings.
- **Candidates are ranked by tier, then score**; blocking defects drive a bounded repair loop.
- **The finished set is judged as a set**: crops from all spreads are tiled beside each sheet and outliers re-rendered.

0
renders that receive another spread's picture as an identity reference

5
identity reference classes in every pack: sheet, cover, objects, companion, world

4
set-level checks: world gate, child / object / companion contact sheets, critical-object set

3
automatic candidates one spread may buy per run, across all gates (default)

> THE GOVERNING RULE
>
> A stateless render can only be held to fixed inputs, and an invariant that no check enforces is an aspiration. The rest of this report is that sentence applied to the child, the outfit, the companion and the objects.

02 Why stateless renders drift
03 The Book Bible
04 Objects
05 Rendering
06 Verification
07 Selection, set gates, ship policy
08 Secondary characters and history
09 Lessons and audit findings

DIAGNOSIS

02 Why twelve stateless renders drift

Before the Book Bible (`ce-9`), the doctrine was already right: fixed inputs, no chaining. What was wrong was how it applied to characters and objects.

CAUSE 1

The fixed inputs were words

Clothing rode as one sentence of garment prose; a comfort toy as a quoted noun; a companion as "Bea, a farmer". An image model weights pictures over prose, so every unpictured detail was per-spread freedom.

CAUSE 2

The anchor was the wrong kind of image

The approved cover is a scene with a title, and it usually crops legs and feet. The garments most prone to drift, hem lengths and shoes, had no pixels behind them.

CAUSE 3

Checks were lenient single-image booleans

QA asked one picture a yes/no question against text. Nothing compared pixels to pixels. Props and companions were not checked at all.

CAUSE 4

Repair was a blind re-roll

One render, a small repair budget, then ship. The cache marker replayed the drifted picture on every later run.

What each trait is held to now

TRAIT	BEFORE CE-9	FIXED INPUT NOW	CHECK NOW
Face, hair, skin	The cover only; no likeness check	Character model sheet, elected once per cover	`same_child`, hair, skin against the sheet; child contact sheet across the set
Clothing	One prose sentence; cropped garments guessed	Outfit spec derived from the sheet, every required slot seen, hex colours per slot	Verdict per slot; garment-band colour distance feeds the score
Personal object	A quoted noun	Prop sheet (front and three-quarter) plus a structured spec	Presence, look, duplication, rendered-as-text; prop contact sheet
Plot object	Whatever the beat implied	Story-object plan: fixed design, instances, per-spread occurrence, state and visibility	Look, presence, `state_match`; a critical-object set check that fails closed
Companion	A noun, on the beats that named it	Companion sheet plus spec; one presence signal over beat and manuscript	Present, `look_match`, duplicated; companion contact sheet

WHY NOT CHAIN THE PREVIOUS SPREAD?

Feeding each render the previous spread looks like the obvious fix. It was deleted: errors compound page by page, compositions converge, and one bad page poisons the rest. Every identity reference is fixed before the first spread renders and is the same for all twelve. Other spreads' pixels reach only the *judge*, in the set gates.

THE FIXED INPUTS

03 The Book Bible: identity as pixels plus a spec

`buildBookBible` runs before any spread renders. The order matters, because later components derive from earlier ones.

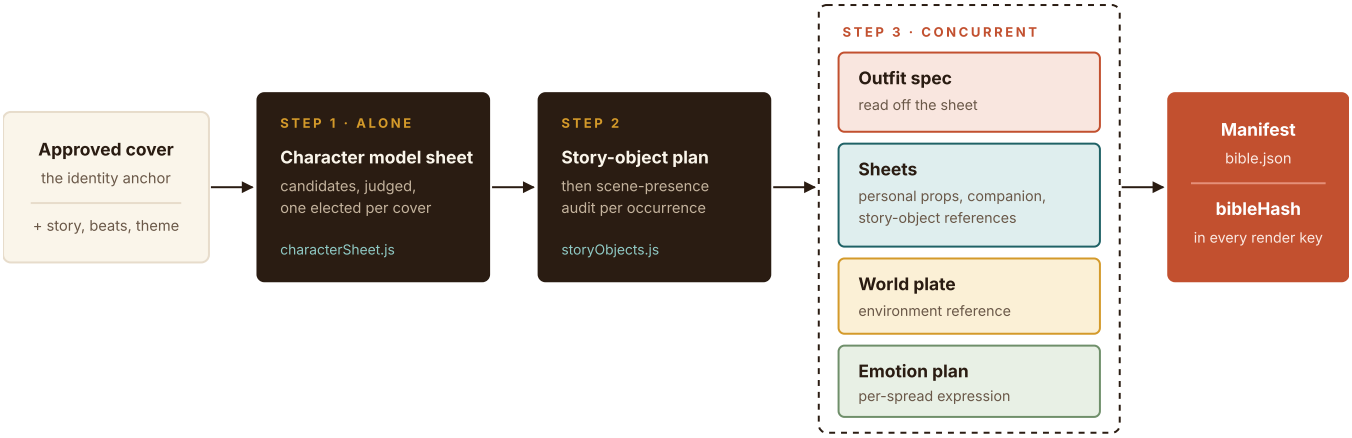


FIG. 1 Build order. The outfit spec needs the elected sheet; reference sheets need the object plan. The four step-3 families build in parallel.

SOURCE
`bible/characterSheet.js`

The character model sheet

One 16:9 image, drawn from the anchor alone and stored once per cover under `catalog-assets/character-sheets/`. A cover is a scene: it crops, poses and lights. The sheet shows every garment from three sides.

SHEET PROMPT · LAYOUT RULES — characterSheet.js

```
three FULL-BODY figures of the SAME child standing side by side in one row —
LEFT: front view, MIDDLE: three-quarter view, RIGHT: back view — standing
relaxed with arms at the sides, head to toe entirely inside the frame, feet and
shoes fully visible on every figure.
two small head-and-shoulders insets in the top corner — one happy, one curious
…
a flat light-grey studio background … NO scene, NO environment, NO props, NO
other people …
```

CALL	IMAGES ATTACHED
Render	The anchor as "REFERENCE 1 — APPROVED CHARACTER". On a repair, the best earlier candidate as "REFERENCE 2 — REPAIR SOURCE" with its defects. The child's photo is never attached.
Judge	The sheet, the anchor, and the raw photo when one exists. If the provider blocks the check with the photo attached, it is asked once more without it.

Acceptance: zero defects, then highest likeness

A candidate passes only when every row below holds. A malformed verdict counts as no verdict, and an unverified sheet is never elected.

VERDICT FIELD	REQUIRED
`figure_count`	exactly 3
`one_child` · `feet_visible` · `anatomy_ok`	true
`outfit_consistent_across_views`	true
`cover_identity_matches`	true
`cover_outfit_matches`	true, with `outfit_findings[]` empty. Each finding names a slot, an attribute, what the cover shows and what the sheet shows.
`likeness` **(to the cover)**	at least 0.8
`sheet_text`	false. Lettering on a garment is clothing: it is copied from the cover and judged as an outfit finding, not as text.
`photo_likeness`	advisory only. Below 0.5 the elected sheet carries a "review the cover" note; it never rejects a candidate.

1. **First round, in parallel**
   Two candidates render and are judged concurrently. If any pass, the one with the highest cover likeness is elected.
2. **Sequential repair**
   The remaining slots (budget 3) render one at a time from the best failing candidate, fewest defects first, with its defect list fed back. The first to pass is elected.
3. **Election**
   Create-if-absent, keyed by the anchor's URL path. A process that loses the race adopts the winner. A process that finds another instance mid-render waits on its claim and adopts the result.
4. **Safety ladder inside each slot**
   `original`, then `sanitized` (the template with no caller text), then `generic-safe`. Only a provider block moves down a rung.

WHEN NO SHEET CAN BE ELECTED

A judge rejection, an exhausted budget or a render failure **pauses** the book as `visual_recovery_pending` with saved evidence, so it can resume. `identity_kit_failed` is raised only when the anchor itself is missing. If the provider refuses to draw on every rung, the book renders on the cover alone with a loud advisory. An explicit regeneration opens a fresh attempt folder and budget; a plain resume replays saved outcomes.

SOURCE
outfitLock.js

The outfit spec

One vision read of the elected sheet returns five slots. `top`, `bottom` and `footwear` are required; `outerwear` may be null; `accessories` is a list of up to six.

SLOT SHAPE — outfitLock.js

```
{ desc: "free text, up to 160 characters, length words mandatory",
  visibility: "seen" | "inferred",  colourHex: ["#rrggbb", … up to 3] }
```

Colour, cut, pattern and length all live in `desc`. On the sheet every required slot must be `seen`; an `inferred` slot is a derivation failure, and the spec falls back to a cover-derived one with an advisory. The slots are rendered into one sentence ("Top: … Bottom: … Footwear: …", 10 to 700 characters). That sentence is what is pinned, hashed, sent to the renderer and given to the judge. The hex values feed the colour metric. The spec is stored by the sheet's content hash under `catalog-assets/outfit-locks/v3/`.

SOURCE
bible/propSheet.js
shared/illustration/ companionKind.js

Personal-object and companion sheets

	PERSONAL OBJECT	COMPANION
Built for	Each distinct `visual_required` evidence value, after normalisation	A companion with both a name and a type
Sheet	Front and three-quarter view, plain light-grey background, no people, no text	Creature: the same layout. Person: a "SECONDARY CHARACTER MODEL SHEET", one fictional person, full body, two views
Content check	`readable_text`, `people_present`, `subject_count`, `single_subject_type`	Person: `figure_count`, `same_person_all_views`, `full_body`, `child_present`
Spec	Kind, colours, hex, material, size relative to the child, marks; one sentence of up to 300 characters	Person: apparent age, build, skin tone, hair, face notes, outfit, hex, marks; up to 420 characters
On failure	Fails open. After a corrective retry and a single-view portrait, the item rides as a quoted noun with a `propSheet` advisory. Nothing here stops a book.	

Person versus creature is decided from the companion's type phrase by one shared word list (farmer, builder, ranger, teacher, wizard and so on). A type the list misses is treated as a creature.

The manifest and its hash

`bibleHash` covers the style version, the anchor, the sheet hash, the outfit hash, every prop's image and spec hash, the companion's, the world plate, the emotion plan and the story-object plan hash. It is folded into every render key, so a change to any of these re-keys the book, and no change replays it for free.

04

OBJECTS

Three kinds of object, three policies

"Object consistency" is three different problems. Treating them as one caused drift in some cases and over-correction in others.

KIND	EXAMPLE	POLICY
Personal object	The child's comfort toy, from the profile	A prop sheet and spec. Required on its declared evidence spread (missing is blocking). On every *later* spread it is carried as a small, subdued continuity prop (not visible is advisory). Only `object_presence` evidence carries; food, place and interest stay on their declared spreads.
Plot object	A route marker, a key, a map	A story-object plan with one fixed design per family, instances, and a per-spread schedule of state and visibility. Plot objects are not held to the "small and decorative" rule.
Anything else	Invented toys, gadgets	The personal-object set is closed. The judge reports `undeclared_object` as an advisory.

WHAT THE RENDERER IS TOLD · PROPS BLOCK — illustrationGenerator.js

```
Carried: Carried by the child in this scene too — small, held or tucked under an arm, visually subdued (…), decorative and comforting only, never a tool, a clue, or part of the plot.
Closed set: These are the ONLY personal objects in this book — do NOT give the child other toys, gadgets, or handheld items. Story objects appear only as specified for THIS scene.
Single plot object: Exactly one instance in this scene; never duplicate it.
Group: A group of matching objects is intentional; each shares this one design. Preserve the individual roles stated in the scene.
Not in this picture: ABSENT FROM THIS PICTURE (…). Its mention or importance is not a request to draw it. Do not insert the family from its reference sheet.
```

SOURCE
storyObjects.js
storyObjectRepair.js

The story-object plan

One text-model call reads the manuscript, the beats, the theme and any authored definitions, and returns up to six object families. The child's personal objects are passed in so the planner excludes them. The plan is elected create-if-absent under `catalog-assets/story-objects/so-1/`, keyed by a hash of its inputs.

PLAN SHAPE (SO-1) — storyObjects.js

```
object { id, name, aliases[≤12], critical, design { shape, material, colors, scale, features },
  instances[1–12] { id, description }, reference?, occurrences[≤12] }
occurrence { spread, instanceIds[], multiplicity: "single" | "group", state, evidence, required }
```

- **Grounded evidence.** The manuscript and beats are cut into numbered passages. The planner cites passage ids; the worker resolves them to exact substrings. A spread whose text names an object but has no occurrence is an omission.

- **Authored designs are fixed.** Changing a catalog definition's name, alias, design or criticality is rejected. Today the catalog authors one object: the `route_marker` of `safari_6_7_watering_hole_map`. Every other plot object is extracted from the manuscript.
- **Identity is separate from visibility.** A moved, damaged or repaired instance keeps its id; only its state changes.
- **Field-scoped completion.** Two whole-plan attempts. Once identities validate, only defective occurrence fields are completed, in batches of eight with two attempts each. A plan with a reported contradiction is never repaired, and a partial plan is never elected.

REFERENCE CONTRACT · REFERENCECONTRACT.JS

What kind of picture is this object's reference?

Each object carries a typed contract: `kind` is single, group, assembly or scene; `subject` is object, creature or landmark. It decides how the sheet is drawn (one object, one coherent group, one assembly with its parts, one context view), how it is judged, and whether set-level tiles are cropped to the object or show the whole spread.

SCENE PRESENCE · SCENEPRESENCE.JS

Is the object actually in this picture?

A noun mention proves a referent, not that it belongs in the frame. One audit call marks every occurrence `visible`, `absent`, `off_screen` or `optional`, citing a manuscript passage. Absent objects leave the reference pack, get the "ABSENT FROM THIS PICTURE" line, and are judged as expected-absent. A family that is never visible gets no sheet.

Reference sheets for plot objects, and how they heal

A reference sheet is itself an AI image and can fail its own check (`design_matches`, `representation_matches`, plus text and unrelated people). Unlike a personal prop, a plot-object reference does not simply fail open. With `CATALOG_REFERENCE_AUTOHEAL` on (the default) it heals in a fixed order:



FIG. 2 Reference auto-heal. A degraded critical object keeps presence, duplication, rendered-as-text and state blocking; only its look becomes advisory, and the set check skips it.

A re-plan may not rewrite a catalog-authored design. Re-plans are applied to copies; the original objects keep the render identities, so artwork already paid for is not re-keyed. An elected sheet is re-verified every time it is loaded.

05

RENDERING

The reference pack and the prompt

SOURCE
bible/index.js
buildReferencePack
illustrationGenerator.js
buildReferenceParts

The pack: fixed order, fixed labels

Each image is sent as `REFERENCE IMAGE n — label`. The label says what the image is for and, as importantly, what not to copy from it. There is no cap on the number of references.

#	REFERENCE	LABEL, ABRIDGED FROM THE CODE
1	Character model sheet	"identity AND the complete outfit of the ONE child ... Use it ONLY for who the child is and what they wear; never copy a pose, expression or the plain studio background."
2	Approved cover	"face, hair, skin tone, and the outfit's colours and materials are ground truth. Identity only — NEVER copy its pose, expression, camera distance, composition, or any lettering it carries."
3...	Object sheets	Visible plot objects first, then declared props, then carried props: "this exact object — same object, colours, material and size whenever it appears".
...	Companion sheet	Only when the companion is on this spread. Person: "the book's ONE recurring companion, a fictional person ... exactly ONE of them."
...	World plate	"match its palette, lighting, era, materials ... Do NOT copy its composition, and NEVER treat it as the scene to draw."

Without a sheet, the cover becomes reference 1, labelled "IDENTITY ANCHOR". In the embedded-text layout the pack also carries a lettering reference, which is outside this report.

SOURCE
illustrationGenerator.js
renderBibleBlocks

The prompt blocks

BIBLE-MODE BLOCKS — illustrationGenerator.js

```
CHARACTER (THE ONLY CHILD IN THIS BOOK — identity and outfit are FIXED by the references):
  - Outfit (every garment, colour, pattern and length EXACTLY as the references and this spec; nothing added, nothing removed, never adapted to weather or activity): <outfit sentence>
PROPS (each quoted name is DATA naming a visual identity; preserve its reference design, colours, material and size, while honoring this scene's state and representation):
  - FIXED DESIGN (data): <design>  THIS SCENE (data): <state>
COMPANION: <name>, a <type> — draw EXACTLY the … FIXED LOOK (data, never to be reinterpreted): <spec> Exactly ONE <name> in the scene — never two, never a look-alike.
```

The spec lives in these blocks. The older prompt sections still run in this mode, but they now point at the references instead of repeating prose, and the final checklist restates the outfit sentence once more. On bath and water spreads the outfit wording changes

and the outfit check is skipped.

One signal decides whether the companion is on a spread

`companionOnSpread` reads the beat and the manuscript text. It fires on the companion's name as a case-sensitive whole word, or on the full type phrase case-insensitively. The world and display names are masked as whole words first, and if the child shares the companion's name only the beat counts. That one result gates the scene line, the sheet in the pack, the COMPANION block and the QA check, so they cannot disagree.

The safety ladder keeps the bible

A render steps down a rung only on a safety block: `original`, then `sanitized` (trigger words stripped from the scene text only; the blocks are rebuilt intact), then `generic-safe` (a calm generic scene with the blocks re-attached). A render accepted below the first rung carries a `render` advisory.

Variety is pinned separately

A strong identity reference pulls every spread toward its pose. A deterministic shot plan, seeded by the story fingerprint, assigns each spread a shot type and staging, so "who" and "how" are pinned by different mechanisms.

KEY PATH

`children-jobs/{bookId}/ce-renders/ {STYLE_VERSION}/ {storyHash}/ spread-N.{aspect}.png`

The cache key is the contract

`storyHash` starts from the book id and spread texts, then folds in the catalog tag and `-b{bibleHash}`. Any change to a sheet, a spec or the object plan therefore re-keys all twelve spreads. In recovery mode the fold is a **per-spread** dependency digest instead (`-d…`): a change to a plot-object reference then re-keys only the spreads that object appears on.

06

VERIFICATION

Pixels checked against pixels

SOURCE

`spreadQa.js`
checkSpreadRenderV2,
classifyDefects

What the judge sees and returns

One vision call per candidate. The render is image 1, followed by the character sheet, each object sheet and the companion sheet. The answer is a schema, not a boolean.

SUBJECT	FIELDS
Identity	`same_child`, `hair_match`, `skin_tone_match`, `age_reads_as_child`. Hair, skin and age are judged only when `same_child` holds.
Outfit	`top`, `bottom`, `footwear`, `outerwear`, `accessories`, each `match | mismatch | not_visible`
Each object	`presence`, `look`, `duplicated`, `as_text` and a bounding box; plot objects add `state_match` (state, roles, count, orientation, spatial clues)
Companion	`present`, `look_match`, `duplicated` and a bounding box
Body	`extra_limbs`, `body_truncated`, `limb_pose_impossible`, `hand_defects`, `face_artifacts`, `child_bbox`
Scene	`child_absent`, `multiple_children`, `undeclared_object`, `face_fully_hidden`, action and emotion fields

The defect ledger

Every finding becomes a fixed string. A string is blocking if it starts with one of the prefixes in `BLOCKING_PREFIXES`; everything else is advisory.

CLASS	DEFECT STRING	CONDITION
BLOCKING	child hero missing · duplicated child hero	
BLOCKING	identity break · hair differs · skin tone differs	Against the character model sheet
BLOCKING	outfit break: <slot> differs from the locked outfit spec	Any visible slot. An outerwear or accessories mismatch needs a second, independent check to confirm it.
BLOCKING	prop missing · prop differs from its reference sheet · prop duplicated · prop rendered as text	"missing" only for a required prop; "differs" only when a sheet exists
BLOCKING	prop state mismatch	A plot object whose state is wrong, or one expected absent that is drawn
BLOCKING	companion missing · companion differs · companion duplicated	When the presence signal expected the companion
BLOCKING	anatomy defect: extra or missing limbs · body incomplete · impossible limb pose	
ADVISORY	age or proportions differ from the character model sheet	Not in the blocking list
ADVISORY	carried prop not visible · undeclared personal object in the scene	

ADVISORY	described story object look differs	A degraded object, which has no sheet
ADVISORY	action break · emotion mismatch · face hidden · hands or fingers · face artifacts	
ADVISORY	Needs visual review: outfit break … (not confirmed by a second check)	The unconfirmed optional-garment case

> **WHEN THE JUDGE CANNOT ANSWER**
> A missing or malformed required field does not produce a defect and does not pass silently. After one retry on the same image, the candidate is marked *unchecked*: it ranks below every checked candidate, no QA marker is written for it, and the render is re-checked on the next run.

SOURCE
`metrics.js`

Measured signals

Two measurements run beside the judge. Neither raises a defect; both only move a candidate's score.

- **Garment colour.** The child's bounding box is cropped and split into three height bands: 15–50% for the top, 50–85% for the bottom, 85–100% for footwear. Each band's dominant colours are compared with the slot's spec hex values. A slot fails when the closest pair is further apart than ΔE 28.
- **Identity embedding** (opt-in, `CATALOG_IDENTITY_METRICS=1`). Cosine similarity between the child crop and the sheet. With six or more spreads, a spread more than two standard deviations from the set is reported to the contact gate as a `character_rendering` outlier.

ACCEPTANCE

07 Selection, repair, set gates and ship policy

SOURCE
`select.js`
`illustrator/index.js`

Ranking: tier first, then score

TIER	CANDIDATE
0	Checked, no blocking defect
1	Checked, has a blocking defect
2	Unchecked

The tier is compared before the score, so a blocking candidate can never outrank a clean one, whatever bonuses it earns. Ties go to the earlier candidate.

SCORE TERM	WEIGHT
Base	+100
Each blocking defect	−120
Each advisory	−10
Each failed colour slot	−15
Identity score s	+40 × (s − 0.5)
Unchecked candidate	fixed 40

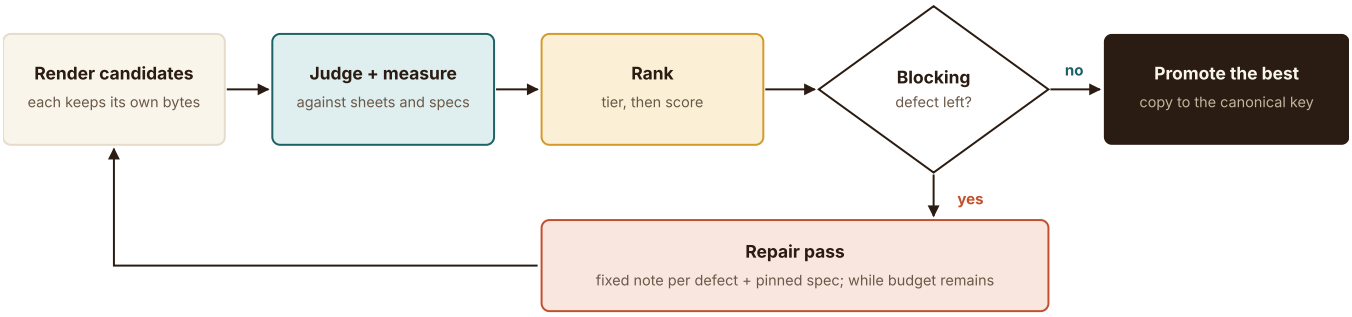


FIG. 3 The per-spread loop. Defaults: one base candidate, one repair pass, three renders in total per spread.

- **Own bytes.** Candidates are stored as `.cK.png` and repairs as `.rPcK.png`; the winner is copied to the canonical key. A rejected repair never overwrites better pixels.
- **Adoption.** A repair replaces the current best when it ranks equal or higher. A repair that clears the blocking defect is kept even with a lower score. A repair the checker could not verify is never adopted and ends the loop.
- **One budget.** Base candidates, repairs and set-gate re-renders all draw on `CATALOG_RENDER_BUDGET_PER_SPREAD` (default 3).
- **Repair notes are templates.** Each defect maps to a fixed note filled only with pinned data: the outfit sentence, a prop name, a reference index.

REPAIR NOTES — spreadQa.js · repairNoteV2

```
OUTFIT REPAIR (<slots>): the child MUST wear EXACTLY the outfit of REFERENCE n and this spec — every garment, colour, pattern and length, nothing added, nothing removed: "<outfit sentence>". Fix ONLY the clothing; keep the scene otherwise identical.
COMPANION REPAIR: "<name>" must appear in this scene exactly once, drawn EXACTLY as REFERENCE n … Exactly ONE of them — remove every second instance or look-alike figure.
```

SOURCE

`contactSheet.js`
`spreadQa.js`
checkWorldConsistency
`index.js`
verifyCriticalObjectSet

Set gates: the book judged as a book

Twelve spreads that each pass against the sheet can still disagree with each other inside the tolerance. After the per-spread phase the run is judged as a set, in this order:

1. **World gate**
   One call over up to twelve spreads at 1024 px, with a closed vocabulary of set breaks, including `character_rendering` (the child reads as a different age, proportions, outfit or hair). Up to three re-renders.

2. **Contact-sheet gate**
   At thumbnail scale a shoe is invisible. So the child is cropped from every spread by its judged box and the crops are tiled beside the model sheet: 384 px tiles, four columns, the reference tile first. The same is done per object sheet, and for the companion over the spreads that expected it. Embedding outliers join here. All of it shares one budget of three re-renders, with one finding per spread.

3. **Critical-object set check**
   For each critical, non-degraded plot object visible on two or more spreads, a contact sheet beside its reference. This check fails closed: an unverified result is recorded as "Critical object set unverified", a failed one as "Critical object changes across spreads". It may re-render cached spreads, into an isolated namespace, and it re-verifies the set afterwards.

The world and contact gates re-render only spreads rendered fresh in this run; replayed renders are comparison references. A gate re-render that comes back worse (more blocking defects, or a lost verdict) is discarded and the original bytes are restored. Repair prompts are built from the closed defect names and cite the sheet's index in the re-render's own pack.

Ship policy and the QA marker

DEFAULT · THE BOOK FINISHES

Ship the best candidate, findings on record

When the budget is spent, a spread ships its best candidate. Blocking residuals, including critical-object failures, ride the callback as advisories with a book-level `shipPolicy` note. A spread with no image at all gets up to three fresh render rounds, then fails `render_failed`.

CATALOG_SHIP_ON_EXHAUSTION=0

Stop and attach the candidates

Any blocking residual fails the run `consistency_unresolved` with every scored candidate attached. An admin can promote one with `/v13/pick-candidate`.

Beside each render a `.qa.json` marker records the byte hash, `QA_VERSION`, the object-plan and scene-presence hashes, the verdict with its bounding boxes, and whether the render shipped unresolved. A cached render is re-checked, not trusted, when the bytes changed, the QA version moved, either object hash differs, or a critical-object failure is on record.

CASE STUDY AND HISTORY

08 Secondary characters, and how we got here

Farmer Bea was two different women

A farm book shipped with its human guide drawn as a different person on two spreads. Both causes were general, and the fix (`ce-19`) treats every named recurring companion like the child.

CAUSE

Person companions had no pixels

Human companions were excluded from the companion sheet because the renderer forbade inventing adult faces. The two human-guide themes (38 books) rendered their guide as a bare noun: no sheet, no spec, no look check, no set gate.

CAUSE

The presence signal never fired

World-name masks were raw substring splits. The farm theme's display name "Farm" is a substring of "Farmer", so "Farmer Bea" became "er Bea" before the name was looked for. No companion line, block or check on any spread.

FIX

A sheet, a spec, and an explicit exception

A person companion gets a secondary-character sheet and a character spec. The COMPANION block states the spec as FIXED LOOK and explicitly allows this one fictional person against the no-other-humans rule.

FIX

One signal, checked like the child

Whole-word masks; one shared person-or-creature decision; `look_match` by face, age, hair, skin, build and outfit; a duplication check; and a companion contact sheet across the set.

Evolution

The early versions each fixed a symptom with more prompt text. The turning point was `ce-9`, which replaced words with pixels and booleans with structured verdicts.

- `pre` Previous-spread chaining deleted as the source of photocopy drift.
- `ce-5` World-law card on every prompt, a fixed world plate, and the first set-level gate.
- `ce-6` Carry-through props: the comfort object persists after its evidence spread.
- `ce-7` Outfit lock: a clothing spec read from the cover and pinned on every render.
- `ce-8` Structured per-slot outfit spec with outfit QA; the deterministic shot plan.
- `ce-9` **The Book Bible and the selection gate.** Character sheet, sheet-derived outfit spec, prop and companion sheets, reference pack, structured judge with sheets attached, candidate ranking, contact-sheet gate.
- `ce-10` Closed personal-object set, subdued carried props, garment patterns in the outfit check.
- `ce-11` Companion presence read from beat and manuscript.
- `ce-19` Person companions get sheets, specs and the companion contact sheet.
- `ce-20` Truncated bodies and impossible limb poses become blocking.
- `so-1` Story-object plan, then reference contracts, scene presence and auto-heal.
- `ce-22` The sheet is drawn from the cover alone; the photo becomes an advisory signal for the judge only.

09

TAKEAWAYS

Lessons, and what the audit found

1. Pin pixels, not adjectives

If an identity matters, give the model a picture of it and the judge a spec of it.

2. One spec for prompt and check

When the same sentence drives the render and the gate, spreads that each pass also match each other.

3. A gate can only reject

Every gate here is paired with a fixed input that makes the right result likely on the first render.

4. Compare at the scale of the defect

Crop the subject and tile the crops beside the reference.

5. Mention is not presence

A noun in the text does not mean the object is in the frame. Decide visibility explicitly, per spread.

6. Repairs speak in templates

Fixed defect strings and pinned data only; a repair is never adopted unverified.

7. References need recovery too

A pinned asset that fails its check replays that failure unless there is an ordered path out.

8. Rank by tier before score

Bonuses must never lift a blocking candidate over a clean one.

9. Hash what changes pixels

Approved art replays byte for byte; only what a change touches re-renders.

Findings from reading the code

This report was first drafted from the project notes and then checked against the source. The check corrected the draft in several places and surfaced the items below. None of them was changed as part of this work.

TYPE	FINDING	DETAIL
POSSIBLE BUG	Durable candidate slots do not key on the reference pack	`illustrator/index.js` passes `renderOpts.referenceImages` into the slot identity, but the field is named `referencePack`, so the value is undefined. The nearby comment says the pack is keyed. Only the root path separates different dependencies. Recovery mode only.
BEHAVIOUR	Age and proportion drift is advisory	"age or proportions differ from the character model sheet" is not in `BLOCKING_PREFIXES`, and it is judged only when `same_child` already holds.
BEHAVIOUR	The colour and embedding metrics never block	They shift the score. With one candidate per spread (the default) there is often nothing for a score to choose between.
BEHAVIOUR	Two spellings of one personal object could attach its sheet twice	The pack's duplicate check uses the raw string, not the normalised value. The pack has no size cap.
DEAD CODE	`bible/faceCrop.js` is unused	Only its own test imports it. Its header still describes the ce-21 design that ce-22 replaced.
DEAD FLAG	`CATALOG_SHEET_PHOTO_LIKENESS_MIN`	Still documented in `flags.js`; no code reads it.

STALE TEXT	Comments and docs that disagree with the code	`contactSheet.js` names `CATALOG_WORLD_QA` as its switch; the code reads `CATALOG_CONTACT_QA`. `select.js` says a blocking defect makes the score negative; a full identity bonus brings one defect to exactly 0 (the tier still protects the ordering). `docs/STORY_OBJECT_CONTINUITY.md` says critical-object residuals always stop the book, and lists the planner as `so-planner-5`; under the default they ship with an advisory, and the planner is at 7.

Module map

MODULE	RESPONSIBILITY
`illustrator/bible/index.js`	Builds the Book Bible, the reference pack and the prompt bible
`bible/characterSheet.js` · `outfitLock.js`	Character model sheet election; outfit spec
`bible/propSheet.js` · `referenceContract.js`	Object and companion sheets, specs, contracts, auto-heal
`storyObjects.js` · `storyObjectRepair.js` · `scenePresence.js`	Story-object plan, field-scoped completion, visibility audit
`scenes.js`	Scene prompt, `companionOnSpread`, continuity props
`spreadQa.js` · `metrics.js` · `select.js`	Structured verdict, measured signals, ranking
`contactSheet.js` · `index.js`	Set gates, repair loop, budgets, ship policy, markers

Switches

SWITCH	DEFAULT	EFFECT WHEN CHANGED
`CATALOG_CHARACTER_SHEET`	on	Off: renders anchor on the cover alone
`CATALOG_SHEET_REQUIRED`	on	Off: a book with no sheet continues with an advisory
`CATALOG_SHEET_CANDIDATES` / `_FIRST_ROUND`	3 / 2	Sheet budget; how many render in parallel first
`CATALOG_PROP_SHEETS`	on	Off: no object or companion sheets
`CATALOG_HUMAN_COMPANION_SHEET`	on	Off: person companions ride as nouns
`CATALOG_PROP_CONTINUITY`	on	Off: the comfort object is not carried
`CATALOG_REFERENCE_AUTOHEAL`	on	Off: a failed plot-object reference pauses the book
`CATALOG_CONTACT_QA` / `CATALOG_WORLD_QA`	on	Off: skip that set gate
`CATALOG_RENDER_CANDIDATES`	1	Base candidates per spread (1–3)
`CATALOG_SPREAD_QA_MAX_REPAIRS`	1	Repair passes per spread (0–4)
`CATALOG_RENDER_BUDGET_PER_SPREAD`	3	All automatic candidates per spread
`CATALOG_SHIP_ON_EXHAUSTION`	on	Off: blocking residuals stop the run
`CATALOG_IDENTITY_METRICS`	off	On: embedding identity score and set outliers